

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition

Capital Projects Group — Rapid Transit Program Controls
Metrolinx, 10 Bay Street

Re: Project Manager, Program Delivery Controls (Job ID 116752)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Project Manager, Program Delivery Controls, Change and Configuration Management position with the Rapid Transit program. I worked at Metrolinx through 2023 and am now an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto, and the part of this role I am most drawn to is what the posting calls independent, evidence-based challenge.

Much of my current work is that kind of review. I read development applications, engineering submissions and consultant studies against City standards, check whether their assumptions hold up, and set out plainly what is missing before anything moves forward. The aim is a better submission rather than a rejected one, and it depends on keeping a working relationship with applicants and consultants whose priorities differ from the City's, which is the collaborative side of challenge the posting describes.

The role also asks for someone to review and validate project data, identify inconsistencies and emerging trends, and improve program-level KPIs, dashboards and reporting. I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of data from separate sources into one validated source the division reports from; most of that work was reconciling sources that did not agree and making the result reliable enough for management to decide from. At Metrolinx my work was establishing what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to service before they were taken forward, which is a form of impact assessment. I also built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions, and set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

I should be straightforward about where I fall short. I have not worked in project controls: I have not managed cost, schedule, risk or contingency baselines, challenged EACs, run change control or configuration management, or led stage-gate reviews, and I have not used EcoSys, Unifier or Power BI. The analytical and review side of the role is familiar to me; the controls discipline itself would be new, and I would expect to learn a good deal from the team.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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